DONALD B. HAVERY

Intelligence Manager

Applied AI · Forward Deployed Engineering · AI Operations · Operations and logistics background

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Scan for the portfolio

SUMMARY

I decide which work goes to AI, build it, and report what it costs and what it returns. Since 2023 I have built AI agents that run in production with the controls around them: tool calling, release tests that fail the build when output gets worse, cost and step limits, and a handoff to a person with the reason attached. I work with the people who do the job to decide which steps an agent should take. I trained new drivers as a company-certified trainer at Peninsula Truck Lines, supervised people at several employers, ran my own businesses with full profit-and-loss responsibility, and have been a line-haul driver at Old Dominion Freight Line since 2022. I want to do this work for one large company.

MEASURED RESULTS

- **Quality.** On a 71-question test of my live customer-service agent, cut wrong answers from 3 to 0. Of the 23 cases still handed to a person, 21 were policy the business had not yet decided, so I listed them as open decisions for the business.
- **Risk.** Took my production agent offline when it answered questions the business had not decided, and turned it back on only after each new guard was proven by a test that fails without it.
- **Model cost.** Moved a grading step from a premium model to a lower-cost one only after the cheaper model passed a calibration set in which about half the answers are built to fail.
- **Spend.** Ran 58 days of daily agent work, 164,039 model calls, on one flat-rate plan that cost about $380. 96.5% of input came from the prompt cache. Source: Claude Code usage records.

SYSTEMS I BUILT

Production customer-service agent (live, private repo): tool-grounded pricing, output guards, reason-coded handoffs, 103-scenario live evaluation, low-cost grading model checked against a test set · **Release gate for LLM and RAG output** · **Agent loop with cost and step ceilings** and failures sorted into six types · **LLM gateway with provider failover** · **Grounded support assistant** that rejects any answer citing a passage it was not given · **Policy-control evidence review** · local voice assistant that skips the model when a stored answer fits

All repositories, with the problem each one solves and who it helps: **dbhavery.dev/repositories**

EXPERIENCE

Founder, independent AI practice and angrynirds web and AI studio 2023 to present

Own the AI budget, the model choices, the builds and the results for my businesses. Live site with Stripe checkout and a production customer-service agent.

Spend and efficiency

- Set hard cost limits in production: an output-token cap, a chat-history cap, an 8-step limit per run, per-visitor and daily call limits, and a switch that keeps the agent off until it is turned on.
- Use the cheapest path that passes its tests: a flat-rate subscription before metered API calls, local open models before frontier ones, and a stored answer with no model call when retrieval confidence is high.
- Built an agent run budget that prices the next call before making it and stops the run at its cost or step ceiling, and an LLM gateway with cross-provider failover, circuit breakers, rate limits and an exact-match response cache.

Deciding what goes to an agent, to code, or to a person

- Map each workflow with the people who run it, then decide which steps an agent takes, which steps code takes, and where a person approves.
- Every agent hands off to a person with a reason code and the transcript. In evaluation, a correct handoff scores as a pass and an unneeded one as a miss.
- The agent tells "the answer was not found" apart from "the business has not decided this," so policy gaps go to the owner and are never guessed.

Measurement and governance

- Release gates: a 103-scenario live evaluation and a CI gate that fails the build when LLM or RAG output gets worse.

Full experience, the results and the decisions behind them: **dbhavery.dev/experience**

Founder and Operator, small businesses 2017 to present

- Grooming brand, 2017 to 2021, with full profit-and-loss responsibility, from formulation and small-batch manufacturing to marketing, fulfillment and customer service.
- Fuel-delivery operations platform (pre-launch) and a CDL training site.

Line-haul Driver, Old Dominion Freight Line 2022 to present

- Class A CDL with hazmat, tanker and triples endorsements, in an operation run on dispatch and federal hours-of-service limits.

Line Driver and Driver Trainer, Peninsula Truck Lines 2017 to 2021

- Company-certified driver trainer: assessed skills, gave road instruction, and signed off new operators to drive unsupervised under DOT safety rules.

Fuel Tanker Driver, Alpha Transport 2012 to 2017

- Hazmat, tanker and oversized loads across Western US routes under FMCSA rules.

SKILLS

AI operations	AI adoption, AI governance, AI platform and FinOps, token spend analysis, cost limits and budgets, cost per result, model selection, ROI reporting, workflow mapping, vendor and pricing models
Agents in production	Agentic AI, tool calling, Model Context Protocol (MCP), human-in-the-loop handoff, escalation, guardrails, kill switches
Evaluation and governance	Evals, regression gates in CI, calibrated LLM judges, RAG metrics, audit trails, license and data controls
Efficiency	Model routing, provider failover, response caching, prompt-cache use, local open models (Ollama, Qwen), cost and step ceilings
Engineering	Python, TypeScript, FastAPI, Next.js, Postgres, SQLite, Docker, Vercel, GitHub Actions, Claude, OpenAI-compatible APIs, Claude Code

EDUCATION AND CONTINUOUS AI LEARNING

Capella University, B.S. Computer Science, GPA 3.95, 2026 | **Capella University**, Master of Business Administration, in progress

Continuous AI learning, 2023 to present. Anthropic certificate: Teaching the AI Fluency Framework, plus Anthropic Academy courses on Claude Code, MCP, and enterprise deployment on Bedrock and Vertex AI | **IBM**, AI Product Manager Professional Certificate | **DeepLearning.AI**, Generative AI with LLMs

Credentials: **dbhavery.dev/credentials**